

1. CORE VISION & TECH STACK

- **Genre:** Turn-based Tactical RPG & Deck-builder hybrid. Combat uses traditional target-selection (like *Final Fantasy 1-9*) without a movement grid.
- **Platforms:** PC, Mac, Android, and iOS.
- **Engine:** Godot Engine (Chosen for true 2D rendering, robust cross-platform mobile support, and superior UI node systems).
- **Visuals:** 16-bit / pixel art graphics. Uses a clean, modern, minimalist UI to evoke a high-tech "Solo Leveling" system vibe that doesn't clutter mobile screens.
- **Audio:** Modern, fully orchestrated soundtrack (HD-2D style) layered over the retro graphics. Sound effects are visceral and high-fidelity.

2. NARRATIVE & LORE

- **The Protagonist:** An orphan with zero innate magical talent, who starts from nothing and survives purely by salvaging trash and common gear from battlefields.
- **The Divine War:** The world is transitioning between the primal Old Gods (who hate technology and want to subjugate humanity) and the New Gods (architects of civilization who demand strict obedience).
- **The 5-Step Plan (The Threat):** The Old Gods are executing a 5-step plan:
 1. Destroy and erase all non-human races.
 2. Destroy the New Gods.
 3. Raze cities and force humans into breeding camps.
 4. Start primal regression via volcanoes, tsunamis, and storms.
 5. Force humans to worship the Old Gods to nurture them.
- **The Twist:** The documents detailing the plan are magical seals. Gathering all 5 parts to "prove" the conspiracy actually acts as a catalyst that triggers the apocalypse.

3. CHARACTERS & PARTY

The player recruits up to 4 named characters with unique class affinities:

- **The Orphan (Protagonist):** A blank slate scavenger outside the gods' control.
- **Brynnael:** A disgraced Elven Healer (Priest/Mage affinity). She was betrayed by a human and is secretly backed by Sylvariel, the New Goddess of Nature and Light.
- **Edward "Blackbeard":** An Undead Rogue. He is a dark variant of a human, cursed by a ghost ship, who joins the party to protect his "un-life" and the criminal underworld from the Old Gods.
- **Seluc:** A massive Orc veteran (Shaman/Monk affinity). He pledges an unbreakable "Life Debt" after the party saves him in a Primal Rift.

4. COMBAT & DECK ENGINE

- **The Deck:** Contains a minimum of 20 cards and a maximum of 50.
- **The Hand:** Players start by drawing 5 random cards. Through leveling up or equipping items, the hand can expand to hold up to 10 cards. Up to 12 cards can be played in a single "overdrive" turn.
- **Mana Economy:** Characters regenerate 5 Mana per turn. The standard Mana cap is 20, but can be expanded via special items. Ultimate AoE nukes (like "Fissure") drain the entire Mana pool.
- **Physical Attacks:** Standard weapons deal slashing, blunt, or elemental damage. Physical attacks have a chance to "proc" (unleash) card abilities from the player's deck at zero Mana cost.
- **Card Burn & Fatigue:** Used cards go to a "Burn Pile" and can be revived mid-combat. If the draw deck runs out, players can manually reshuffle, but they suffer a "Fatigue" penalty (mana burn or stat debuffs).
- **AI & Bosses:** Standard enemies use fixed AI attack patterns for efficient grinding. Bosses use a hybrid of fixed AI and their own randomized ability decks. Boss combos are telegraphed one turn in advance to allow players to prepare.

5. CLASSES & SKILLS

- **Fluid Class System:** Advanced classes are determined dynamically by the ratio of base cards (Warrior, Mage, Priest, Rogue) in a character's 50-card deck. High-tier gear (like a legendary necklace) can act as an "anchor," forcing a class override. Class changes visibly alter the 16-bit character sprites.
- **Skill Waking:** Characters passively awaken skills (like Locksmithing or Learn) when specific conditions are met.
- **The "Learn" Skill (Blue Mage):** Players can permanently steal boss abilities. These scaled boss cards drain massive Mana, or act as one-time consumable "Boss Essence" cards.
- **Unplayable/Dormant Cards:** Incredibly powerful cards that are "dead draws" until the player equips a specific weapon or plays a specific combo of cards first (Exodia setups).

6. LOOT & ECONOMY

- **The 8 Tiers:** Trash (Gray), Common (White), Magic (Blue), Rare (Yellow), Epic (Purple), Legendary (Orange), Mythic (Red), and Unique (Green).
- **Cursed Gear:** Rolls with incredibly high stats but applies devastating drawbacks (like blinding the party). Cursed gear cannot be unequipped until it is blessed by a priest.
- **Card Crafting:** The Arcane Synthesizer/Card Forge allows players to fuse identical cards (Slash + Slash = Slash+) or combine elements (Slash + Ember = Flame Arc).

- **Gear Enhancement:** Instead of bloated raw crafting, players use ores and materials to upgrade the rarity of existing gear or "Imbue" weapons by permanently burning an ability card onto them.

7. THE GUILDHALL (Base Building)

- **Location:** Starts as an abandoned Heretic's Shack on the outskirts of a medium city.
- **Upgrades:** Rooms are built using Gold, Materials (Wood, Ore, Rock), and Primal Essence.
- **The Barracks (Dispatch System):** Players recruit generic RNG mercenaries. Instead of selling low-level Trash/Common gear, players equip it to these recruits and dispatch them on passive material-gathering missions.
- **Upkeep:** The Guild has a "Positive Upkeep" system. Paying for supplies grants a "High Morale" buff (+XP, faster dispatch times) rather than punishing the player.

8. WORLD & EXPLORATION

- **Traversal:** Fully explorable zones (Octopath Traveler style) with an overworld map for fast travel.
- **Encounters:** Standard enemies trigger via invisible random encounters. Bosses and Uber Bosses are visually present on the field.
- **Primal Rifts:** Dynamic, limited-time dungeons that spawn on the map. They contain elite enemies, Primal Essence, Mythic gear, and offer "Skill Waking" opportunities.
- **Solving "Dead Zones":** Low-level areas remain relevant via scaled dynamic chests, Metroidvania ability locks (e.g., Locksmithing doors), replayable bosses, and fetch quests from the Dispatch Board.

9. MONETIZATION

- **Model:** Traditional premium paid game.
- **Marketing:** A massive, free demo will be released that lets players experience the intro, the Heretic's shack, and combat right up until they recruit the fourth character (Seluc).